

Spring Framework vs Spring Boot

Feature	Spring Framework	Spring Boot
What it is	A powerful IoC/DI + modular framework for Java	A tool to bootstrap Spring apps with zero-config
Setup	Manual XML or Java config, many decisions	Auto-configuration — just run
Configuration	You write <bean>, web.xml, dispatchers, etc.	Almost none — sensible defaults
Dependencies	You add each Spring module (Core, MVC, Data, etc.)	spring-boot-starter-* bundles everything
Embedded Server	Need external Tomcat/Jetty + WAR	Built-in Tomcat/Jetty — run as JAR
Production Ready	You add metrics, health checks	Actuator gives /health, /metrics out-of-box
Use Case	Full control, legacy, custom setup	90% of new apps — fast start

